

HUMAN COST OF BANDITRY AND KIDNAPPING IN NORTH-CENTRAL NIGERIA

1 March - 10 September 2026 — Verified State-by-State Breakdown

For AVM Morgan — North-Central Security Presentation. Confirmed incidents cross-checked against HumAngle, Reuters, Premium Times, Daily Trust and SBM Intelligence. Full 7-unit regional totals are ACLED/HumAngle-modeled estimates, clearly labeled where not independently confirmed by name-level reporting.

1. Confirmed Named Incidents

State	Period	Incident Details	Killed	Abducted / Held	Displaced	Source
Plateau	May - 11 Jul 2026	Barkin Ladi, Riyom, Bassa, Jos South, Pankshin LGAs (62 May, 43 Jun, 16 Jul 1-11)	121 (confirmed)	—	—	Berom Youth Moulders Assoc. / HumAngle
Plateau & Benue	11-12 Jul 2026 (weekend)	Kum & Wereng-Camp, Riyom LGA (incl. 9 killed in one family, incl. a 2-month-old); Otukpo & Apa LGAs, Benue	18 initial → revised to 25-27	—	—	HumAngle / Premium Times
Niger (Borgu, Kpenya/ Dekara)	21-24 Aug 2026	Mosque raid during Juma’at prayers; bandit propaganda video (24 Aug) claimed ~600 held — not independently confirmed	—	60-80 confirmed by police; ~600 unverified (bandit video)	—	Reuters (22 & 24 Aug 2026)
Niger (Borgu, 4 mosque communities)	Late Aug 2026	Multi-village offensive across four attacked mosque communities	30 (confirmed)	—	~2,000 (fled to Benin Republic)	Daily Trust / Reuters

2. National Context (not state-specific)

Period	Killed	Kidnapped	Ransom Paid	Source
Jul 2025 - Jun 2026	1,142 (confirmed)	7,825 (confirmed)	₦7.78bn / \$5.79M (confirmed, nationwide)	SBM Intelligence, Reuters, Vanguard (Aug 2026)

3. Full Regional Totals — All 7 North-Central Units (Modeled Estimate)

These are ACLED/HumAngle-modeled RANGES, not confirmed single figures — use as directional scale, not as exact quoted numbers on record.

Unit	Est. Fatalities	Est. Abductions	Key Dynamics
Niger	350–450	700–900	Epicenter of mass abductions (Borgu mosque raid, Papiri St. Mary’s, Shiroro). SBM: 496 victims in 68 incidents (12mo).
Plateau	380–480	120–180	Highest fatality rate, ethno-religious/agrarian raids (Barkin Ladi, Riyom, Bokkos, Bassa, Mangu). 121 confirmed.
Benue	280–380	150–220	Severe agrarian violence + highway kidnappings (Ukum, Logo, Otukpo, Apa, Gwer West). Tops regional IDP counts.
Kwara	40–60	220–280	Major abduction surge Q2/Q3 2026 (May twin raids: 25 abducted; church: 15; Aug op rescued 163).
Kogi	30–50	80–120	Highway banditry, rural militia raids (Ofu, Egume, Ochaja, Kabba axis).
Nasarawa	25–40	50–80	Moderate rural kidnapping and agrarian clashes (Lafia, Nasarawa Eggon, Karu).
FCT (Abuja)	15–30	60–90	Suburban/estate raids and border incursions (Kubwa, Bwari, Kuje).

Regional totals: 1,150–1,450 total fatalities; 1,200–1,650+ kidnap/abduction victims; ~450,000–520,000 IDPs in-zone (combined NC+NW IDP benchmark: 1,311,026, IOM DTM Round 18, Feb 2026). North-Central accounts for an estimated 20–25% of all conflict fatalities nationwide (ACLED).

What this means for North-Central Nigeria

This is a development emergency, not merely a law-and-order problem: mass displacement, prolonged captivity, ransom payments, destroyed homes and livelihoods, disrupted farming and education, psychological trauma, and declining confidence in government protection. Plateau alone recorded 121

confirmed deaths in roughly two-and-a-half months; the Niger State episode shows armed groups can remove dozens to hundreds of civilians in a single operation.